

statement has been industriously copied by his successors, no one taking the trouble to test the matter. In the second edition of Cornill's *Einleitung*, p. 268, one could even read that Jerome(!) was the author of the Vulgate version of our apocryphon. Nestle (*Marginalien und Materialien*, p. 29, n. 2) says that "the Lucian recension" (meaning the text printed in Lagarde's *Librorum vet. test. canonicorum pars prior graece*) furnished the basis of the Syriac translation; a theory which would seem plausible for the first nine verses of the first chapter, but from that point on is seen to be absolutely false. There has not even been made a careful comparison of the two Greek versions, the canonical and the apocryphal, as they stand in our printed Greek Bibles, to say nothing of inquiries as to their nature, history, and mutual relations. Even for the restoration of the massoretic Hebrew text of Chronicles-Ezra-Nehemiah, no critical use of even the current Greek text of First Esdras has ever been made. A few (most recently Guthe, in the *Polychrome Bible*) have included "The Greek Ezra" in their apparatus in a more or less haphazard and superficial way, but such attempts as these can have no considerable value.

The one scholar who in recent times has defended the view that First Esdras represents a Greek translation which is older than the one contained in the corresponding books of our canonical Greek Bible is Sir Henry Howorth, who has argued the case more than once,² with much learning and acumen. This view had been held, in one form or another, by not a few scholars; among them Grotius, in his annotations, 1644; Whiston, *Essay towards Restoring the True Text of the Old Testament*, 1722; Pohlmann, "Ueber das Ansehen des apokr. iii. Buchs Esras," *Tübing. theol. Quartalschrift*, 1859, pp. 257-75; Ewald, *Gesch. des Volkes Israel*, IV, 1864, p. 166; and Lagarde, *Psalterium Hieronymi*, 1874, p. 162, note. No one of these scholars, however, set forth the view so fully and vigorously as Howorth, nor do they seem to have appreciated, as he has, the great importance of this conclusion. Nevertheless, the proof which Howorth has been able to bring forward is by no means conclusive; the skeptic would not

²In the *Academy*, 1893, January 7 and 21, February 4 and 25, April 15, June 17, July 22; in the *Transactions* of the Ninth International Congress of Orientalists at London, Vol. II (1893), pp. 69-85; and (most fully, and including the substance of all the previous articles) in the *Proceedings of the Society of Biblical Archaeology*, May, 1901, pp. 147-59, November, 1901, pp. 305-30, June, 1902, pp. 147-72, and November, 1902, pp. 332-56.